



Imagine a creature so small, you can barely see it with your naked eye. This is the world of lice, tiny insects that make their home in the fur or hair of various animals, including humans. They have six legs, each tipped with a claw, which they use to cling to hair or fur. Most lice are about the size of a sesame seed, so you can imagine how tiny they are!



Now, you might be wondering where these super small critters live and what they eat. Lice are found all over the world, living on the bodies of their hosts. What they eat depends on their species - some feed on blood, while others prefer skin and hair debris. They can't fly or jump, so they move around by crawling.

Speaking of crawling, let's talk about the life cycle of these little crawlers. A louse begins life as a nit (egg) that's glued to a hair or fur. In about a week, the nit hatches into a nymph (a young louse), which grows into an adult louse in another week. Adult lice can live for about a month, laying several eggs a day during their lifetime.



So, we know lice are tiny, crawl around, and have a pretty quick life cycle, but what's their relationship with us humans and other animals? Well, lice are mostly known for being pests. They can cause itchiness and discomfort, and in large numbers, they can even cause anemia in their host. But here's a fun fact: Lice are specific to their hosts, which means human lice won't live on pets, and vice versa!



Solve each problem.

Use the article to answer the question.

- 1) How many legs does a louse have?
A. four B. six C. eight D. two
- 2) Where would you most likely find lice making their home?
A. In rivers B. Under the sand at the beach
C. High up in trees D. In fur or hair
- 3) What is the size of a lice?
A. the size of a sesame seed B. the size of a pack of gum
C. about 8 inches D. the size of a watermelon
- 4) Can human lice live on pets?
A. Yes B. Only on dogs C. No D. Only on cats
- 5) Lice in large numbers can cause _____ in their hosts.
A. anemia B. blindness C. hearing loss D. gingivitis
- 6) What part do lice use to cling to hair or fur?
A. claws on their legs B. their abdomen pincher
C. their sticky body D. their sharp teeth
- 7) How long does it take for a nit to hatch into a nymph?
A. about a day B. about a year
C. about a week D. about a month
- 8) How long can an adult louse live?
A. about a year B. about a month
C. about a day D. about a week
- 9) What do lice not feed on?
A. Blood B. Tree bark C. Hair debris D. Skin
- 10) What are lice mostly known for?
A. being friendly B. being helpful C. being pests D. being cute

Determine if the statements is something the animal would say (W) or it it is not something the animal would say (N).

- 11) "We lice are huge, almost the size of an apple!"
- 12) "I just love to fly around and soar in the sky!"
- 13) "Can you believe, we can survive pretty much anywhere in the world."
- 14) I use my eight long legs to crawl around.
- 15) "I enjoy hopping from one place to another!"
- 16) "I can eat anything, from fruits to meat."
- 17) "I can't fly or jump, so I have to crawl to get around."
- 18) "We have a quick life cycle. We go from egg to adult in only two weeks."
- 19) "I use my six legs, each with a claw, to strongly hold onto hair and fur."
- 20) "My life span is about a year."
- 21) "I eat grass and leaves."
- 22) "We lice are friends of humans, we never cause any harm."

- 23) "Some of us feast on skin and hair bits, while others prefer a meal of blood."
- 24) "We lice can only hop or fly."
- 25) "As an adult, I can live for about a month and I will lay several eggs every day."
- 26) "My life began as an egg, then I transform into a nymph, and finally into an adult louse."
- 27) "I started my life as a nit (which is a little egg), glued to a hair strand."
- 28) "We don't lay eggs, we give birth to live young ones."
- 29) "You might find it hard to see me, I'm so tiny, about as small as a sesame seed."
- 30) "Did you know, if there's too many of us, we can cause anemia in our host."

Determine if the statement is a fact or opinion based on the information in the article.

- 31) Lice cannot fly or jump, but they can crawl to get around.
- 32) It's pretty neat how lice have claws to cling on to hair.
- 33) Lice are found globally, making their homes on the bodies of various animals and humans.
- 34) Lice and fleas are the two most disgusting bugs.
- 35) Lice possess six legs, equipped with claws that help them cling onto hair or fur.
- 36) The fact that lice are specific to their hosts is an interesting adaptation.
- 37) Human lice won't survive on pets, and vice versa.
- 38) The diet of lice may consist of blood, or skin and hair debris, depending on the species.
- 39) Lice are gross and creepy.
- 40) Lice are fascinating because of their quick life cycle.

Determine if the statement is true or false.

- 41) Lice are tiny insects that are so small you can barely see them with your naked eye.
- 42) Baby lice take several years to grow into adults.
- 43) Adult lice can live for about a month.
- 44) Lice have eight legs just like a spider.
- 45) The life cycle of a louse begins as an egg that's glued to a hair or fur.
- 46) Lice are only found in North America.
- 47) Lice can only fly for short distances.
- 48) All lice feed on blood.
- 49) Lice eat blood, skin, and hair debris.
- 50) Lice are insects that live in the fur or hair of various animals, including humans.

Determine which choice is the expanded form of the underlined contraction.

- 51) There's a special comb to remove lice and nits.
A. there are
B. there is
C. there has
D. there was
- 52) If you've got lice, it's important to treat them.
A. you have
B. you had
C. you will
D. you could
- 53) Lice can't fly or jump like other insects.
A. will not
B. are not
C. should not
D. cannot

- 54)** Lice aren't the same as fleas or ticks.
A. are not
C. do not
B. will not
D. is not
- 55)** Human lice don't live on pets.
A. did not
C. do not
B. does not
D. will not

Determine if the sentence is a declarative(d), exclamatory(e), interrogative(i) or imperative(m).

- 56) Lice infestations can happen to anyone, regardless of how clean your hair is!
- 57) Please don't scratch your head if you have lice!
- 58) How are lice different from other insects?
- 59) Wow, lice can move from one head to another so quickly!
- 60) Lice are small, wingless insects that live on human hair.
- 61) Do lice only live on humans?
- 62) The life cycle begins when a female louse lays her eggs, called nits, on human hair strands.
- 63) Do lice carry any diseases?
- 64) Lice can cause itching and irritation on our scalp when they feed on our blood.
- 65) Please comb your hair slowly and carefully to remove lice.
- 66) Yuck, lice crawl around on your scalp!
- 67) Avoid sharing items like hats, combs, or headphones to prevent the spread of lice.



Lice

Name: _____

- | | | |
|-----------|-----------|-----------|
| 1. _____ | 26. _____ | 51. _____ |
| 2. _____ | 27. _____ | 52. _____ |
| 3. _____ | 28. _____ | 53. _____ |
| 4. _____ | 29. _____ | 54. _____ |
| 5. _____ | 30. _____ | 55. _____ |
| 6. _____ | 31. _____ | 56. _____ |
| 7. _____ | 32. _____ | 57. _____ |
| 8. _____ | 33. _____ | 58. _____ |
| 9. _____ | 34. _____ | 59. _____ |
| 10. _____ | 35. _____ | 60. _____ |
| 11. _____ | 36. _____ | 61. _____ |
| 12. _____ | 37. _____ | 62. _____ |
| 13. _____ | 38. _____ | 63. _____ |
| 14. _____ | 39. _____ | 64. _____ |
| 15. _____ | 40. _____ | 65. _____ |
| 16. _____ | 41. _____ | 66. _____ |
| 17. _____ | 42. _____ | 67. _____ |
| 18. _____ | 43. _____ | |
| 19. _____ | 44. _____ | |
| 20. _____ | 45. _____ | |
| 21. _____ | 46. _____ | |
| 22. _____ | 47. _____ | |
| 23. _____ | 48. _____ | |
| 24. _____ | 49. _____ | |
| 25. _____ | 50. _____ | |



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1.	B	26.	Would	51.	B
2.	D	27.	Would	52.	A
3.	A	28.	Not	53.	D
4.	C	29.	Would	54.	A
5.	A	30.	Would	55.	C
6.	A	31.	fact	56.	exclamatory
7.	C	32.	opinion	57.	imperative
8.	B	33.	fact	58.	interrogative
9.	B	34.	opinion	59.	exclamatory
10.	C	35.	fact	60.	declarative
11.	Not	36.	opinion	61.	interrogative
12.	Not	37.	fact	62.	declarative
13.	Would	38.	fact	63.	interrogative
14.	Not	39.	opinion	64.	declarative
15.	Not	40.	opinion	65.	imperative
16.	Not	41.	true	66.	exclamatory
17.	Would	42.	false	67.	imperative
18.	Would	43.	true		
19.	Would	44.	false		
20.	Not	45.	true		
21.	Not	46.	false		
22.	Not	47.	false		
23.	Would	48.	false		
24.	Not	49.	true		
25.	Would	50.	true		